

1. Defence & Military Exercises

Super Garuda Shield Exercise	
Countries	USA and Indonesia (bilateral, joint military exercise)
Type	Military / Army exercise
Host	Indonesia
Start Date	11th September 2026
First Held	2006
Participating Countries	13 countries (in addition to the 2 host/lead nations)

Related Exercises to Remember	
Garuda Shakti	India & Indonesia
Yudh Abhyas 2026	India & USA — Army exercise; upcoming 2nd edition; host nation not yet finalised
Vajra Prahar	India & USA
Tiger Claw	Exercise series (name to remember)
Tiger Triumph	Exercise series (name to remember)
Austra Hind	India & Australia
Samudra Shakti	India & Indonesia — recently concluded 5th edition
Ajay Warrior	India & UK
Konkan Exercise	India & UK (naval)
Freedom Edge	USA, Japan & South Korea (trilateral)
Maitree Exercise	India & Thailand

Note: A dedicated lecture on all 2026 Defence Exercises was scheduled for the 4 PM session the same day — revise that content alongside this list.

2. UPI Goes International — Uzbekistan

UPI Full Form	Unified Payments Interface
UPI Launch Year	2016 (completed 10 years; anniversary covered on 25th August)
Regulator of UPI	NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India)
NPCI Formed	2006 (started operations 2007)
Regulator of NPCI	RBI (Reserve Bank of India)
Newest Country for UPI	Uzbekistan — 11th country where Indian UPI will work
Context	PM Modi's 2-day visit to Uzbekistan; capital Tashkent; conferred with Uzbekistan's highest civilian award
Uzbekistan's Own Digital Payment System	HUMO — linked with UPI via QR code scanning for cross-border payment
10th Country for UPI (previous)	Colombia
UPI Transactions (July 2026, India)	Approx. ₹30 lakh crore

3. SCO Summit & PM Modi's Diplomatic Awards

Summit	SCO (Shanghai Cooperation Organisation) Summit
Venue	Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan
Edition	26th Edition
India & Pakistan as Members Since	2017
Controversy	Pakistan removed PM Modi's photo from the official group photo published in its media

Other Sites Visited by PM	Lal Bahadur Shastri Memorial (Tashkent); Mahatma Gandhi University, Tashkent
Sports Event Attended	World Nomad Games — 6th Edition, held in Uzbekistan

PM Modi's International Honours (selected list)	
Order of King Abdulaziz	Saudi Arabia
Order of Amanullah Khan	Afghanistan
Order of Izzuddin	Maldives
Order of the Nile	Egypt
Order of Niger	Nigeria
Total International Awards	36 (35 from countries + 1 from FAO)

4. Global Combat Aircraft Programme (GCAP)

Full Form	Global Combat Aircraft Programme (also called "Tempest Mission")
Started	2022 (concept from 2002)
Founding Members	UK, Italy, Japan
Objective	Develop a 6th-generation, AI-enabled fighter aircraft
India's New Role	Added as a "Dialogue Partner" (can discuss/participate but has no rights over the technology)
Target Completion	2034
Comparable Example	BrahMos — a true joint venture (India-Russia) where India owns the technology, unlike GCAP's dialogue-partner status

5. NASA's New Space Telescope

Name	Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope
Named After	Nancy Grace Roman — American astronomer, first Chief of Astronomy at NASA (also called "Mother of Hubble")
Launched From	Kennedy Space Center, Florida, USA
Launch Rocket	SpaceX Falcon 9
Nickname	"Mother of Hubble" — mirror size 2.4 metres; images ~100 times sharper than Hubble Telescope
Mission Objective	Study dark matter (95% of the universe is unexplained "dark" content)
Orbital Position	Placed at Lagrange Point L2 (compare: India's Aditya-L1 solar mission is placed at L1)
NASA HQ / Chief	Washington DC; current NASA chief — Sean/Isa-Mac (as referenced in class)

6. Static GK Revision (Mixed Questions)

- Indus Valley** Lothal — an ancient port city of the Indus Valley Civilisation, located in Gujarat.
- Ancient India** Founder of the Haryanka Dynasty — Bimbisara (not Bindusara, who came later).
- Modern India** Pitt's India Act — passed in 1784 (came after the Regulating Act of 1773).
- Modern India** First Finance Minister of Independent India — R. K. Shanmukham Chetty.
- Labour Law** Children below the age of **14 years** are prohibited from employment under Indian law.

7. Ramon Magsaysay Award 2026

Given By	Philippines
Started In	1958 (President Ramon Magsaysay died in 1957; award instituted in his memory)
Known As	"Nobel Prize of Asia"
Categories	6 categories, largely for work in humanity / human rights / diplomacy
Current Edition	68th Edition
2026 Recipients (all Asian)	Tomy — Singapore Bo Ki (Boki) — Myanmar Ruksana/Rukhan — Bangladesh

2025 Recipients (previous year)	Shaheena Ali (Maldives) and Flaviano
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Indian Recipients of the Ramon Magsaysay Award	
Acharya Vinoba Bhave	1958 — first Indian recipient
Mother Teresa	1962
Kailash Satyarthi	1997
Arvind Kejriwal	2006
Ravish Kumar (mentioned as most recent Indian awardee)	2023

8. Other National & International Awards (2026)	
Miss Universe 2026	Won by Kajia / Kaziya — hails from Kerala
Sarala Puraskar 2026 (Poetry, Odisha)	Ashutosh Parida
Lokmanya Tilak Award (Pune)	Ajit Doval
Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar 2025	Acharya Goswami
Gold Medal in Physics (first Indian-origin recipient)	Jitendra Jain

9. Turkey Joins Artemis Accords	
Development	Turkey becomes the 71st member of the Artemis Accords
Turkey — Capital	Ankara
Turkey — Currency	Lira
Turkey — Location	Mostly in Asia; European portion known as Istanbul; lies between the Black Sea and the Mediterranean Sea
Turkey — Head of Government	President Erdogan

About the Artemis Mission

Purpose	Lunar mission — send astronauts to the Moon and return them to Earth
Duration	10 days; crew of 3–4 astronauts
Launched (mission start)	2020

Vaibhav Suryavanshi — Dileep Trophy Record	
Achievement	Fastest half-century in domestic cricket at age 15
Tournament	Dileep Trophy (domestic cricket tournament hosted by BCCI)
Fifty Scored In	42 balls
Total Score in Innings	92 runs (approx. 81–82 balls)
Team	East Zone (vs Central Zone)
Venue	Bengaluru
Record Broken	Lakshman Singh's 57-year-old record (from 1969)
Record Still Standing	Sachin Tendulkar — youngest to score a century (100 runs) in the Dileep Trophy, at age 17
Dileep Trophy Started	1961–62
Current Champions	Central Zone

11. Sports — Football	
FIH / Football Awards & ISL	
Best Male Player	Lalianzuala Chhange
Best Female Player (India)	Manisha Kalyan
ISL Championship 2025–26	Won by East Bengal — 12th Edition; announced after the Durand Cup

Lionel Messi — Retires from International Football	
Born	Rosario, Santa Fe, Argentina
Development	Announced retirement from international football (continues playing for his club)
Total International Goals	125

Quick Revision — All MCQs from Today's Class	
Q1. What is the name of the joint military exercise between the USA and Indonesia starting on 11th September 2026? (A) Yudh Abhyas (B) Super Garuda Shield Exercise (C) Garuda Shakti (D) Vajra Prahar	
Answer: (B) Super Garuda Shield Exercise	
Q2. "Garuda Shakti" exercise is conducted between which two countries? (A) India & USA (B) India & Indonesia (C) India & Australia (D) India & UK	
Answer: (B) India & Indonesia	

Total Members Now	71 countries (latest: Turkey)
India's Membership	Joined 2023 — 27th member country
Announcement Location	NASA Headquarters, Washington DC
Spacecraft	Orion spacecraft
Related Mission (for revision)	Axiom-04 mission — carried Shubhanshu Shukla to space and back; his book is titled <i>"The Second Orbit"</i>

10. Sports — Cricket	
Women's Champions Trophy 2027 — Hosting Rights Withdrawn	
Organiser	ICC (International Cricket Council) — HQ in Dubai, formed 1909; Chairperson: Jay Shah
Original Host	Sri Lanka
Reason for Withdrawal	ICC cited corruption concerns and non-compliance with rules and regulations in Sri Lanka
Planned Format	6 teams; originally scheduled to start 14th February 2027
New Host	Not officially announced — widely speculated to shift to India

Other Upcoming Cricket Events	
Men's ODI World Cup 2027	To be jointly hosted by South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia
Asia Cup 2027 (Men's)	To be hosted by Bangladesh
T20 World Cup (recent)	Won by India

Goal Contributions	185
Hat-tricks	11
FIFA World Cup 2022 (Doha, Qatar)	Winner — Argentina
FIFA World Cup (recent, hosted by USA/Canada/Mexico)	Argentina — runner-up, lost to Spain
Ballon d'Or Wins	8 times (highest in football)
Copa America Titles	2 (2021 and 2024)
Olympic Gold Medal (team)	2008
Major International Titles	3 (2 Copa America + 1 FIFA World Cup)
Current Club	Inter Miami — contract runs until 2028
Retirement Letter Written On	21st July 2026 (handwritten; announced later)

12. Sports — Tennis: Hall of Fame Inductees	
Inductee 1	Roger Federer — 271st inductee; from Switzerland; first player to win 20 Grand Slam titles
Inductee 2	Mary (broadcast journalist) — 272nd inductee
For Reference	Sourav Ganguly recently inducted into Cricket Hall of Fame; Rafael Nadal is associated with the French Open

13. Economy — One-Liner	
India's GDP growth rate for Q1 (first quarter) stood at approximately 7.8%.	

Q3. "Yudh Abhyas 2026" (2nd edition) is a joint exercise between India and which country? (A) Australia (B) UK (C) USA (D) Japan	
Answer: (C) USA	
Q4. Which country recently became the 11th nation where India's UPI is now operational? (A) Colombia (B) Uzbekistan (C) Kazakhstan (D) Sri Lanka	
Answer: (B) Uzbekistan	

Q5. Who regulates the NPCI in India?

- (A) SEBI
- (B) Ministry of Finance
- (C) RBI
- (D) IRDAI

Answer: (C) RBI

Q6. What is the name of Uzbekistan's own digital payment system now linked with UPI?

- (A) PayNow
- (B) HUMO
- (C) Mir
- (D) Click

Answer: (B) HUMO

Q7. Which country was the 10th nation to adopt UPI, before Uzbekistan?

- (A) Cambodia
- (B) Colombia
- (C) Nepal
- (D) Mauritius

Answer: (B) Colombia

Q8. The 26th SCO Summit (2026) was held in which city?

- (A) Tashkent
- (B) Bishkek
- (C) Astana
- (D) Dushanbe

Answer: (B) Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

Q9. India and Pakistan became members of the SCO in which year?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 2016
- (C) 2017
- (D) 2018

Answer: (C) 2017

Q10. PM Modi received the "Order of King Abdulaziz" award from which country?

- (A) UAE
- (B) Egypt
- (C) Saudi Arabia
- (D) Qatar

Answer: (C) Saudi Arabia

Q11. "Order of Amanullah Khan" was conferred on PM Modi by which country?

- (A) Iran
- (B) Afghanistan
- (C) Maldives
- (D) Nigeria

Answer: (B) Afghanistan

Q12. The "Order of the Nile" award (given to PM Modi) belongs to which country?

- (A) Egypt
- (B) Nigeria
- (C) Sudan
- (D) Kenya

Answer: (A) Egypt

Q13. As of the latest count, how many total international awards has PM Modi received?

- (A) 30
- (B) 33
- (C) 36
- (D) 40

Answer: (C) 36

Q14. GCAP stands for:

- (A) Global Combat Air Program
- (B) Global Combat Aircraft Programme
- (C) General Combat Aviation Plan
- (D) Global Coalition Aircraft Programme

Answer: (B) Global Combat Aircraft Programme

Q15. Which countries are the founding members of GCAP?

- (A) USA, UK, Japan
- (B) UK, Italy, Japan
- (C) France, Germany, UK
- (D) Japan, South Korea, Italy

Answer: (B) UK, Italy, Japan

Q16. India has joined GCAP in what capacity?

- (A) Full Member
- (B) Observer
- (C) Dialogue Partner
- (D) Technology Partner

Answer: (C) Dialogue Partner

Q17. GCAP aims to develop which generation of fighter aircraft?

- (A) 4.5 Generation
- (B) 5th Generation
- (C) 6th Generation
- (D) 7th Generation

Answer: (C) 6th Generation

Q18. NASA's new space telescope, launched to study dark matter, is named after:

- (A) Katherine Johnson
- (B) Nancy Grace Roman
- (C) Sally Ride
- (D) Margaret Hamilton

Answer: (B) Nancy Grace Roman

Q19. The Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope was launched using which rocket?

- (A) Falcon Heavy
- (B) Ariane 5
- (C) Falcon 9
- (D) SLS

Answer: (C) Falcon 9 (SpaceX)

Q20. Why is the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope nicknamed "Mother of Hubble"?

- (A) It was launched before Hubble
- (B) Its images are about 100 times sharper than Hubble's
- (C) It orbits the same point as Hubble
- (D) It replaced Hubble in orbit

Answer: (B) Its images are about 100 times sharper/better than Hubble's

Q21. Where has the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope been placed in space?

- (A) L1 Lagrange Point
- (B) L2 Lagrange Point
- (C) Low Earth Orbit
- (D) Geostationary Orbit

Answer: (B) L2 Lagrange Point

Q22. Lothal, an ancient port city of the Indus Valley Civilisation, is located in:

- (A) Rajasthan
- (B) Gujarat
- (C) Haryana
- (D) Punjab

Answer: (B) Gujarat

Q23. Who was the founder of the Haryanka Dynasty?

- (A) Bindusara
- (B) Bimbisara
- (C) Ajatashatru
- (D) Chandragupta Maurya

Answer: (B) Bimbisara

Q24. In which year was Pitt's India Act passed?

- (A) 1773
- (B) 1784
- (C) 1793
- (D) 1858

Answer: (B) 1784

Q25. Who was the first Finance Minister of independent India?

- (A) C. D. Deshmukh
- (B) Morarji Desai
- (C) R. K. Shanmukham Chetty
- (D) T. T. Krishnamachari

Answer: (C) R. K. Shanmukham Chetty

Q26. The Ramon Magsaysay Award is given by which country?

- (A) Indonesia
- (B) Philippines
- (C) Malaysia
- (D) Vietnam

Answer: (B) Philippines

Q27. The Ramon Magsaysay Award is popularly known as:

- (A) Nobel Prize of Asia
- (B) Asian Peace Prize
- (C) Order of Merit
- (D) Asia's Legion of Honour

Answer: (A) Nobel Prize of Asia

Q28. Who was the first Indian to receive the Ramon Magsaysay Award, and in which year?

- (A) Mother Teresa, 1962
- (B) Vinoba Bhave, 1958
- (C) Kailash Satyarthi, 1997
- (D) Arvind Kejriwal, 2006

Answer: (B) Acharya Vinoba Bhave, 1958

Q29. Turkey has become the 71st member of which international accord?

- (A) Paris Agreement
- (B) Artemis Accords
- (C) Abraham Accords
- (D) I2U2

Answer: (B) Artemis Accords

Q30. India joined the Artemis Accords in which year, becoming the 27th member?

- (A) 2020
- (B) 2021
- (C) 2022
- (D) 2023

Answer: (D) 2023

Q31. The Artemis mission announcement was made from NASA's headquarters located in:

- (A) Houston
- (B) Florida
- (C) Washington DC
- (D) California

Answer: (C) Washington DC

Q32. Under Indian law, employment of children below what age is prohibited?

- (A) 12 years
- (B) 14 years
- (C) 16 years
- (D) 18 years

Answer: (B) 14 years

Q33. ICC withdrew the hosting rights of the Women's Champions Trophy 2027 from which country?

- (A) Bangladesh
- (B) Sri Lanka
- (C) Pakistan
- (D) Afghanistan

Answer: (B) Sri Lanka

Q34. The Men's ODI World Cup 2027 will be jointly hosted by South Africa, Zimbabwe and:

- (A) Kenya
- (B) Namibia
- (C) Botswana
- (D) Uganda

Answer: (B) Namibia

Q35. Asia Cup 2027 (Men's) will be hosted by:

- (A) India
- (B) Pakistan
- (C) Bangladesh
- (D) Sri Lanka

Answer: (C) Bangladesh

Q36. Vaibhav Suryavanshi set the fastest domestic half-century record at what age?

- (A) 13
- (B) 14
- (C) 15
- (D) 16

Answer: (C) 15 years

Q37. Vaibhav Suryavanshi's record-breaking half-century (in the Dileep Trophy) came off how many balls?

- (A) 35 balls
- (B) 42 balls
- (C) 50 balls
- (D) 60 balls

Answer: (B) 42 balls

Q38. Whose 57-year-old record did Vaibhav Suryavanshi break?

- (A) Sachin Tendulkar
- (B) Lakshman Singh
- (C) Sunil Gavaskar
- (D) Virender Sehwag

Answer: (B) Lakshman Singh (record set in 1969)

Q39. The Dileep Trophy is organised by:

- (A) ICC
- (B) BCCI
- (C) ACC
- (D) State Cricket Association

Answer: (B) BCCI

Q40. Who became the ISL (Indian Super League) champions for 2025–26, 12th edition?

- (A) Mohun Bagan
- (B) East Bengal
- (C) Bengaluru FC
- (D) Mumbai City FC

Answer: (B) East Bengal

Q41. Lionel Messi was born in which city?

- (A) Buenos Aires
- (B) Rosario
- (C) Cordoba
- (D) Mendoza

Answer: (B) Rosario, Argentina

Q42. In the recent FIFA World Cup final, Argentina (with Messi) finished as runner-up, losing to:

- (A) France
- (B) Brazil
- (C) Spain
- (D) Germany

Answer: (C) Spain

Q43. How many times has Lionel Messi won the Ballon d'Or?

- (A) 6
- (B) 7
- (C) 8
- (D) 9

Answer: (C) 8 times

Q44. Which club does Lionel Messi currently play for (contract until 2028)?

- (A) Paris Saint-Germain
- (B) FC Barcelona
- (C) Inter Miami
- (D) LA Galaxy

Answer: (C) Inter Miami

Q45. Roger Federer, recently inducted into the Tennis Hall of Fame, belongs to which country?

- (A) Spain
- (B) Switzerland
- (C) Serbia
- (D) UK

Answer: (B) Switzerland

Q46. Roger Federer was the first player to achieve which milestone in Grand Slam tennis?

- (A) First to win Career Grand Slam
- (B) First to win 20 Grand Slam titles
- (C) First to reach World No. 1
- (D) First to win Olympic Gold

Answer: (B) First player to win 20 Grand Slam titles

Q47. India's GDP growth rate for the first quarter (Q1) of the year stood at approximately:

- (A) 6.8%
- (B) 7.2%
- (C) 7.8%
- (D) 8.4%

Answer: (C) 7.8%